



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Akron
School Website: <https://akronchestertonacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Chesterton Academy of Akron

Website audited: <https://akronchestertonacademy.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Chesterton Academy of Akron presents clear textual evidence of a classical, Catholic educational model. The site explicitly anchors its mission in the true, the good, and the beautiful; integrates theology across subjects; lists Great Books authors; and names the Socratic method as a primary pedagogy. Liturgical life (daily Mass, Adoration, Confession) is present, and a House System fosters virtue and community. The new St. Thomas More Junior Classical (grades 7–8) extends this model into the middle school years with catechism memorization, Latin prayers, and contemplative practices like journaling and silence. On balance, positive indicators from the Six Essential Elements outnumber negatives by a wide margin in every category, with only a mild “college outcomes” emphasis appearing in a few places.

Key highlights: - Mission and identity highlight classical formation in truth, goodness, and beauty, “in partnership with families and the Church.” - Classical curriculum featuring integrated humanities, explicit Great Books authors, history (not “social studies”), and the Socratic method. - Substantial liturgical and devotional life for students, especially in grades 7–8 (daily Mass, Adoration, Confession), plus catechism memorization and Latin prayers. - Faculty expectations emphasize participation in daily Mass and leadership in spiritual formation and House life.

Scoring framework used: Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators) and the classicality lexicon.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

1) Keyword identification (from school site)

- Positive terms found: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; culture of life; Catholic faith; theology (integrated); Mass; Adoration; Confession; catechism; Latin prayers. Examples:
 - “True, Good, and Beautiful” (mission/identity)
 - “Our school aims to educate young people in the virtues of Truth, Goodness and Beauty.”
 - “Catholic theology integrated into each subject.”
 - Daily Mass, Adoration, Confession; catechism memorization; Latin prayers.
- Negative terms found: none

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Strong matches to positive indicators for transcendental moral realism (truth/goodness/beauty; virtue) and theological grounding (theology, catechesis, faith and reason) and liturgical/communal practices (Mass, Adoration, Confession).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 12
- Negative hits: 0
- Positive ratio: 100% (12/12)
- Coverage of sub-criteria: 100% (transcendentals, theology, liturgy all present)

4) Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal

1) Keyword identification (from school site)

- Positive terms found: classical tradition; formation; virtues; prudence, temperance, fortitude, justice; truth/goodness/beauty; joyful leaders and saints.
- Potential negatives: mentions of “entrance exams,” “accepted to top universities,” and “scholarships” in a college-context paragraph.

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Strong alignment with purpose as cultivation of wisdom and virtue, formed by the transcendentals.
- Minor presence of outcomes language that can drift toward college-placement emphasis (a negative indicator if dominant), but here it appears subordinate to formation aims.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 9
- Negative hits: 2 (college outcomes emphasis)
- Positive ratio: 82% (9/11)
- Coverage of sub-criteria: 90% (formation and transcendentals explicit; “education as formation rather than information” implicit but present)

4) Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 3: Curriculum

1) Keyword identification (from school site)

- Positive terms found: classical curriculum; integrated humanities; Socratic method; Great Books authors (Homer, Chaucer, Dante, Shakespeare, Dickens, Dostoevsky); history sequence (Ancient → Modern); Euclidean/Analytical Geometry; theology; choir/music; Latin (prayers at Jr. Classical).
- Negative terms found: none (no “social studies,” no STEM-first framing, no project-based-dominance language)

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Direct matches to Trivium/Rhetoric/Socratic, Great Books/primary texts, integrated approach, and wonder-inducing arts.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 10
- Negative hits: 0
- Positive ratio: 100% (10/10)
- Coverage of sub-criteria: 100%

4) Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods

- 1) Keyword identification (from school site)
 - Positive terms found: Socratic method; respectful dialogue/logic; classical-style lessons; memorization (catechism); singing/choir; contemplative practices (journaling, silence, prayer).
 - Negative terms found: none prominent (no emphasis on “project-based,” “experiential-only,” or “student-directed” dominance)
- 2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon
 - Aligns with Socratic/dialectic, memorization/recitation, and restful learning (elements of scholé via silence/journaling/prayer), plus music/choir.
- 3) Quantitative estimate
 - Positive hits: 6
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Positive ratio: 100% (6/6)
 - Coverage of sub-criteria: 80% (Socratic, memory/singing, contemplation present; upper-school rhetoric/orations not explicitly stated on the site pages crawled)
- 4) Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty

- 1) Keyword identification (from school site)
 - Positive terms found: faithful, passionate, Catholic teachers; faculty participate in daily Mass; lead retreats; engage House system; read original texts; virtue and holiness emphasis; VIRTUS training.
 - Negative terms found: none
- 2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon
 - Indicates teachers as mentors/models of virtue, with collegial leadership in liturgical/community life and classical pedagogy.
- 3) Quantitative estimate
 - Positive hits: 5
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Positive ratio: 100% (5/5)
 - Coverage of sub-criteria: 75% (portrait-of-a-teacher document not visible; otherwise strong)
- 4) Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents and Community

- 1) Keyword identification (from school site)
 - Positive terms found: “in partnership with families and the Church”; Come & See nights for parents and students; newsletter; House system fosters tangible community.
 - Negative terms found: none
- 2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon
 - Partnership with parents is explicit; evidence of community events is strong. Less explicit is ongoing “parent formation” programming.
- 3) Quantitative estimate

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- Positive hits: 3
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Positive ratio: 100% (3/3)
 - Coverage of sub-criteria: 60% (partnership and events present; formal parent education not observed)

4) Category score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating

- Category ratings: [C1: CLASSICAL, C2: CLASSICAL, C3: CLASSICAL, C4: CLASSICAL, C5: CLASSICAL, C6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]
- Overall school assessment: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school demonstrates strong, explicit adherence to all core elements of classical education across mission, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and religious life. Parent/community formation is solid but could be strengthened with systematic parent education offerings.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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